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APPSC GROUP-1 MAINS
2026–27

Paper III

Polity, Constitution, Governance, Law & Ethics

Previous questions, sorted by syllabus · with practice questions



90 Previous questions
2020, 2023 and 2025 papers

9 Syllabus parts
how many came from each

54 Practice questions
on every part, including recent news

BY

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Syllabus as per APPSC Notification 07/2026

Paper III at a glance

How many previous questions came from each part of the syllabus.

30 questions in the 2020 paper + **30** questions in the 2023 paper + **30** questions in the 2025 paper = **90** questions in this book

Each paper has 15 questions, and each question gives a choice of (a) or (b), so 30 questions per paper. Questions 1–5 are on Polity, 6–10 on Administration & Governance, and 11–15 on Ethics & Law.

Part	Syllabus part	2020	2023	2025	Total	Page
1	The Constitution and our rights	2	1	3	6	2
2	Centre and States: sharing power and money	2	4	3	9	3
3	Panchayats and municipalities	2	1	1	4	5
4	Parliament and State Legislatures	2	2	2	6	7
5	Courts and judicial review	2	2	1	5	9
6	Running the government: administration, policies and civil services	6	6	6	18	10
7	Good governance and the citizen's voice	4	4	4	12	13
8	Ethics for public servants	8	8	8	24	15
9	Everyday laws: civil, criminal, labour, cyber and tax	2	2	2	6	17
	All parts	30	30	30	90	

ASKED THE MOST

Ethics for public servants

24 of 90 questions, about 1 in every 4.

RISING THE MOST

Part 2: 2 → 4 → 3

Centre and States: sharing power and money, in 2020, 2023, 2025.

ASKED THE LEAST

Panchayats and municipalities

Only 4 of 90 questions.

Each part of this book has three things: ① how many questions came from each topic ② the exact questions asked ③ practice questions to write.

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PART 1 OF 9

The Constitution and our rights

1

What the Constitution is, how it was made, the rights it gives us, and its emergency and amendment rules.

6	2	1	3
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
How the Constitution was made and its main features	2	0	0	**2**
Fundamental Rights, Directive Principles and how rights are protected	0	1	1	**2**
Jobs and duties of the Union and State governments	0	0	1	**1**
Emergency powers and changing (amending) the Constitution	0	0	1	**1**

2 The questions asked

How the Constitution was made and its main features

asked 2 times

2020 Q1(a) — How was the Constituent Assembly formed that framed the Indian constitution? Critically evaluate the Constitution of India as framed by the Constituent Assembly.

2020 Q4(b) — Explain any five salient features of the Indian Constitution

Fundamental Rights, Directive Principles and how rights are protected

asked 2 times

2025 Q5(a) — The Constitution of India grants certain rights to citizens and also provides measures to safeguard them. What are the key constitutional arrangements to ensure the protection of these rights?

2023 Q1(a) — Examine the scope of 'reasonable restrictions' and the 'test of reasonableness' in connection with Article 19 of the Indian Constitution.

Jobs and duties of the Union and State governments

asked 1 time

2025 Q1(b) — The Indian Constitution favours a federal type of government. Considering this, what duties does the Constitution place on State Governments to ensure the smooth functioning of the nation?

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Emergency powers and changing (amending) the Constitution

asked 1 time

2025 Q1(a) What are the emergency functions of the Union Government of India? Describe how they impact the legislative powers of Parliament and State Legislatures.

3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS, DIRECTIVE PRINCIPLES AND HOW RIGHTS ARE PROTECTED ● IN THE NEWS

In 2025, the Supreme Court said that digital access is part of the right to life under Article 21. Explain this judgement and why it matters for persons with disabilities.

P2 JOBS AND DUTIES OF THE UNION AND STATE GOVERNMENTS ● IN THE NEWS

The Constitution (130th Amendment) Bill, 2025 proposes that a Prime Minister, Chief Minister or minister held in custody for 30 days must lose office. Discuss the arguments for and against it.

P3 EMERGENCY POWERS AND CHANGING (AMENDING) THE CONSTITUTION ● IN THE NEWS

Fifty years after the 1975 Emergency, explain the safeguards added by the 44th Amendment to prevent misuse of emergency powers.

P4 FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS, DIRECTIVE PRINCIPLES AND HOW RIGHTS ARE PROTECTED

What are the Directive Principles of State Policy? How are they different from Fundamental Rights? Give examples of Directive Principles that have become laws.

P5 EMERGENCY POWERS AND CHANGING (AMENDING) THE CONSTITUTION

What is the 'basic structure' of the Constitution? Why is it called the guardian of the Constitution?

P6 HOW THE CONSTITUTION WAS MADE AND ITS MAIN FEATURES

Why is the Indian Constitution sometimes called a 'borrowed Constitution'? Explain its main sources and what makes it uniquely Indian.

PART 2 OF 9

Centre and States: sharing power and money

2

How power and money are shared between the Centre (Union) and the States, and what the Governor does.

9	2	4	3
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
Federalism: a strong Centre, Centre–State friction and cooperation	1	1	0	**2**
The Governor's role and powers	1	1	0	**2**
Who makes which laws: Union, State and Concurrent Lists	0	1	2	**3**
Sharing money: Finance Commission and fiscal federalism	0	1	1	**2**

2 The questions asked

Federalism: a strong Centre, Centre–State friction and cooperation

asked 2 times

2023 Q1(b) — Explain the genesis of the Inter-State Council and discuss its relevance in the context of Centre-State and Inter-State coordination and cooperation in India.

2020 Q2(a) — Why did we adopt federalism with a strong central government? Explain the important provisions that create a strong central government.

The Governor's role and powers

asked 2 times

2023 Q2(a) — The office of the Governor in certain situations carries with it the exercise of discretionary functions and special responsibilities. Discuss this statement in view of the constitutional provisions.

2020 Q3(b) — Explain the role of Governor in states by focusing on its powers and functions.

Who makes which laws: Union, State and Concurrent Lists

asked 3 times

2025 Q2(a) — The procedure of enacting a law from a bill differs at the Union and State levels, primarily to safeguard the interests of the Union Government in state legislation. Elucidate this aspect.

2025 Q2(b) — Although States have their separate list for law-making, this authority is not beyond the overarching legislative powers of the Parliament. Examine.

2023 Q2(b) — The National Education Policy (2020) has been criticized as denuding the autonomy of states. In this connection, examine the rationale behind the transfer of matters from the State list to the Concurrent list.

Sharing money: Finance Commission and fiscal federalism

asked 2 times

2025 Q3(a) — The Finance Commission is considered the backbone of fiscal federalism in India. Examine its role and significance in maintaining the financial balance between the Union and the States.

2023 Q3(b) — 'The Finance Commission, though not being a permanent body, has still maintained its credibility by promoting fiscal democracy in India,' - Comment.

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3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 THE GOVERNOR'S ROLE AND POWERS ● IN THE NEWS

In November 2025, the Supreme Court said courts cannot fix time limits for Governors to act on State Bills. Explain the Governor's powers over State Bills and the debate around them.

P2 SHARING MONEY: FINANCE COMMISSION AND FISCAL FEDERALISM ● IN THE NEWS

The 16th Finance Commission kept the States' share of central taxes at 41%. Explain the role of the Finance Commission and how its decisions affect States like Andhra Pradesh.

P3 FEDERALISM: A STRONG CENTRE, CENTRE–STATE FRICTION AND COOPERATION ● IN THE NEWS

Why are southern States worried about the delimitation of Lok Sabha seats after the next Census? Suggest a fair solution.

P4 WHO MAKES WHICH LAWS: UNION, STATE AND CONCURRENT LISTS

What are the Union, State and Concurrent Lists? Explain with examples how a conflict between a Union law and a State law is settled.

P5 FEDERALISM: A STRONG CENTRE, CENTRE–STATE FRICTION AND COOPERATION

What is cooperative federalism? Explain the role of NITI Aayog and the GST Council in promoting it.

P6 SHARING MONEY: FINANCE COMMISSION AND FISCAL FEDERALISM

What was 'Special Category Status'? Explain the debate over it for Andhra Pradesh after the State's bifurcation.

PART 3 OF 9

Panchayats and municipalities

3

How villages (panchayats) and towns (municipalities) govern themselves under the 73rd and 74th Amendments.

4	2	1	1
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
73rd and 74th Amendments: what panchayats and municipalities get	2	0	1	**3**
Women and weaker sections in local bodies	0	1	0	**1**
Bodies that back local government (State Election Commission, State Finance Commission)	0	0	0	**0**

2 The questions asked

73rd and 74th Amendments: what panchayats and municipalities get

asked 3 times

2025 Q3(b) — Discuss the significance of the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act in strengthening grassroots democracy in India.

2020 Q3(a) — Describe the main features of the 73rd and 74th amendment of the Indian Constitution.

2020 Q5(b) — Describe the salient features of the Rural and Urban Local Governance under the 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment Act.

Women and weaker sections in local bodies

asked 1 time

2023 Q3(a) — Discuss the scope and challenges involved in the political empowerment of women through the Panchayat Raj. Briefly suggest on how to enhance women empowerment in rural and urban local governance.

Bodies that back local government (State Election Commission, State Finance Commission)

not asked yet

3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 WOMEN AND WEAKER SECTIONS IN LOCAL BODIES ● IN THE NEWS
What is 'sarpanch pati' (husbands running panchayats in place of elected women)? Suggest steps, including those recommended by a government committee in 2025, to make women's leadership real.

P2 73RD AND 74TH AMENDMENTS: WHAT PANCHAYATS AND MUNICIPALITIES GET ● IN THE NEWS
Why are local body elections delayed in many States? Discuss with reference to recent Supreme Court directions.

P3 BODIES THAT BACK LOCAL GOVERNMENT (STATE ELECTION COMMISSION, STATE FINANCE COMMISSION)
What are the powers and functions of the State Election Commission and the State Finance Commission? Why are they important for local bodies?

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P4 BODIES THAT BACK LOCAL GOVERNMENT (STATE ELECTION COMMISSION, STATE FINANCE COMMISSION)
What are the main sources of income for panchayats? Why do they depend so much on grants from the State?

P5 73RD AND 74TH AMENDMENTS: WHAT PANCHAYATS AND MUNICIPALITIES GET
What powers does the 74th Amendment give to municipalities? Why are many Indian cities still not governed well?

P6 73RD AND 74TH AMENDMENTS: WHAT PANCHAYATS AND MUNICIPALITIES GET
What is the Gram Sabha? How can it make village government more democratic and accountable?

PART 4 OF 9

Parliament and State Legislatures

4

How Parliament and the State Assemblies and Councils are built, make laws and run their business.

6	2	2	2
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha: make-up and powers	1	0	0	**1**
How a Bill becomes law; motions and House business	0	1	1	**2**
State Legislatures, Legislative Councils and privileges	1	1	1	**3**

2 The questions asked

Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha: make-up and powers

asked 1 time

2020 Q4(a)

Differentiate between the powers of the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha on the basis of the following parameters: functions and control over election. Explain, with reasons, the powers that are exercised only by the Lok Sabha.

How a Bill becomes law; motions and House business

asked 2 times

2025 Q4(a)

What are the steps followed by the Indian Parliament in transforming a Bill into an Act?

2023 Q4(a) Briefly discuss the different kinds of motions used to discuss matters in the Parliament. Comment on the difference between motions and resolutions.

State Legislatures, Legislative Councils and privileges

asked 3 times

2025 Q4(b) In what aspects is the Legislative Council (Vidhan Parishad) different from the Rajya Sabha, considering its role at the state level?

2023 Q4(b) Describe the matters in which the Legislative Council stands equal with the Legislative Assembly along with the matters in which it stands unequal with the Legislative Assembly.

2020 Q2(b) Define Privileges of state legislature and classify it into two broad categories.

3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 HOW A BILL BECOMES LAW; MOTIONS AND HOUSE BUSINESS ● IN THE NEWS
In the 2025 Monsoon Session, Parliament worked for only about a third of its scheduled time. Why do disruptions happen, and how can Parliament work better?

P2 LOK SABHA AND RAJYA SABHA: MAKE-UP AND POWERS ● IN THE NEWS
How is the Vice-President of India elected? Explain the Vice-President's role as Chairman of the Rajya Sabha, with reference to the 2025 election.

P3 STATE LEGISLATURES, LEGISLATIVE COUNCILS AND PRIVILEGES ● IN THE NEWS
How is the Leader of Opposition in a State Assembly recognised? Discuss with reference to the 2025 debate in the Andhra Pradesh Assembly.

P4 HOW A BILL BECOMES LAW; MOTIONS AND HOUSE BUSINESS
How is a Money Bill different from an ordinary Bill? Who decides whether a Bill is a Money Bill?

P5 STATE LEGISLATURES, LEGISLATIVE COUNCILS AND PRIVILEGES
Should every State have a Legislative Council? Discuss the arguments for and against, with reference to Andhra Pradesh.

P6 HOW A BILL BECOMES LAW; MOTIONS AND HOUSE BUSINESS
What are parliamentary committees? Why are they called 'mini-Parliaments'?

PART 5 OF 9

Courts and judicial review

5

How the courts are organised and how they check laws and government action.

5	2	2	1
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
How courts are organised; amendments affecting the courts	0	0	1	**1**
Judicial review: courts checking laws and orders	1	1	0	**2**
Public Interest Litigation (PIL) and judicial activism	1	1	0	**2**

2 The questions asked

How courts are organised; amendments affecting the courts

asked 1 time

2025 Q5(b) — Discuss any two constitutional amendments that have significantly affected the powers or functioning of the Indian judiciary.

Judicial review: courts checking laws and orders

asked 2 times

2023 Q5(a) — Discuss the scope of Judicial review in reviewing administrative action, legislative enactments and judicial decisions.

2020 Q1(b) — Define Judicial Review with special reference to the classification given by Justice Syed Shah Mohamed Quadri. Describe the importance and scope of Judicial Review.

Public Interest Litigation (PIL) and judicial activism

asked 2 times

2023 Q5(b) — What is meant by Public Interest Litigation (PIL)? Describe the nature of court orders that are passed by courts in PIL cases.

2020 Q5(a) — Define judicial activism with special reference to PIL and SAL. Judicial activism has had manifold impact on the political system. Justify the statement adding suitable arguments.

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3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 JUDICIAL REVIEW: COURTS CHECKING LAWS AND ORDERS ● IN THE NEWS

In 2025, the Supreme Court put some provisions of the Waqf (Amendment) Act on hold. Explain the power of judicial review and when courts can stop a law from operating.

P2 PUBLIC INTEREST LITIGATION (PIL) AND JUDICIAL ACTIVISM ● IN THE NEWS

What is judicial activism? Discuss its benefits and risks, with recent examples such as the Supreme Court's 2025 orders on stray dogs.

P3 HOW COURTS ARE ORGANISED; AMENDMENTS AFFECTING THE COURTS

How are judges of the Supreme Court and High Courts appointed? Discuss the debate over the collegium system.

P4 HOW COURTS ARE ORGANISED; AMENDMENTS AFFECTING THE COURTS

How can a judge of the Supreme Court or a High Court be removed? Why is this process so rarely completed?

P5 HOW COURTS ARE ORGANISED; AMENDMENTS AFFECTING THE COURTS

Why are so many cases pending in Indian courts? Suggest reforms to deliver faster justice.

P6 PUBLIC INTEREST LITIGATION (PIL) AND JUDICIAL ACTIVISM

How has Public Interest Litigation helped the poor? How can its misuse be prevented?

PART 6 OF 9

Running the government: administration, policies and civil services

6

How the government machine works: its history, its development policies, its civil servants and its special bodies.

18	6	6	6
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
What public administration is and its history (Kautilya to British rule)	2	2	2	**6**
Government development policies and why implementation falls short	2	1	2	**5**
Civil services: role, reforms and integrity	1	2	0	**3**
Statutory, regulatory and quasi-judicial bodies (commissions, tribunals)	1	1	2	**4**

2 The questions asked

What public administration is and its history (Kautilya to British rule)

asked 6 times

2025 Q6(a) — The administrative system of the Gupta dynasty was, in many ways, similar to that of the Mauryan Empire. Discuss the key similarities and differences between the two administrative structures.

2025 Q6(b) — What features of British administration have influenced the Indian administrative system?

2023 Q6(a) — 'The concept of the welfare state had been crystallised in Kautilya's ideas long before it came to be envisioned in Western Europe' - Examine this statement.

2023 Q6(b) — It is observed that much of present-day Indian bureaucracy is a result of British administration. In this connection, explain the evolution of Civil Service in India.

2020 Q6(a) — Define public administration and explain its evolution in India.

2020 Q6(b) — Differentiate between the administrative ideas in Kautilya's Arthashashtra and the Mughal administration.

Government development policies and why implementation falls short

asked 5 times

2025 Q7(a) — Education is a vital sector for boosting the development of any nation. Highlight the recent developments in the education policy of the Indian government.

2025 Q7(b) — Although policies formulated by departments are prepared by experts, the results often fall short of expectations. What are the major issues responsible for this gap between policy formulation and implementation?

2023 Q7(a) — Government's intervention in development has seen a long way of impressive outcomes in India. In this connection, discuss the Atmanirbhar Bharat mission aimed at making India Self-Reliant.

2020 Q7(a) — Define ‘development’ as explained by Prof. Amartya Sen. Explain the characteristics of the new development thinking, and also mention the four areas where the government has to play a crucial role.

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2020 Q10(b) Explain the major governmental interventions in the social sector with special reference to Health and education.

Civil services: role, reforms and integrity

asked 3 times

2023 Q7(b) Explain the scope of civil service reforms in India with a brief note on Mission Karmayogi.

2023 Q9(b) What are the reasons for decline of integrity in civil services? Also, discuss the institutional mechanism to check corruption in India.

2020 Q7(b) Describe the role of NGOs and Civil Services in Democracy.

Statutory, regulatory and quasi-judicial bodies (commissions, tribunals)

asked 4 times

2025 Q9(a) Under which Act was the National Commission for Women (NCW) established? Describe its main features and limitations.

2025 Q9(b) Which constitutional provisions empower the formation of quasi-judicial authorities in India? Explain with suitable examples.

2023 Q9(a) Explain the quasi-judicial nature of Administrative Tribunals. Examine whether writs and appeals are available against the decisions of the Administrative Tribunals.

2020 Q9(a) Describe the work of the statutory bodies with example and mention in which countries they are set up. Explain quasi-judicial bodies, providing two examples from India.

3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 GOVERNMENT DEVELOPMENT POLICIES AND WHY IMPLEMENTATION FALLS SHORT · IN THE NEWS
What is Andhra Pradesh's P4 (Public-Private-People Partnership) model, 'Margadarsi–Bangaru Kutumbam'? Can it reduce poverty?

P2 STATUTORY, REGULATORY AND QUASI-JUDICIAL BODIES (COMMISSIONS, TRIBUNALS) · IN THE NEWS
In November 2025, the Supreme Court struck down parts of the Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021. Why is the independence of tribunals important?

P3 STATUTORY, REGULATORY AND QUASI-JUDICIAL BODIES (COMMISSIONS, TRIBUNALS)
What are regulatory bodies? Explain the role of any two regulators, such as RBI, SEBI or TRAI, in protecting citizens.

P4 CIVIL SERVICES: ROLE, REFORMS AND INTEGRITY
What is lateral entry into the civil services? Discuss its benefits and concerns.

P5 WHAT PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION IS AND ITS HISTORY (KAUTILYA TO BRITISH RULE)
Describe the main features of administration under the Vijayanagara Empire.

P6 GOVERNMENT DEVELOPMENT POLICIES AND WHY IMPLEMENTATION FALLS SHORT
What is the Aspirational Districts Programme? How has it helped backward districts develop?

PART 7 OF 9

Good governance and the citizen's voice

7

How citizens and civil society keep government open and answerable: NGOs, e-governance, RTI and social audit.

12	4	4	4
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
Civil society and NGOs	1	1	2	**4**
Good governance, e-governance and Citizen's Charter	1	2	0	**3**
Right to Information (RTI) and Public Service Act	1	1	1	**3**
Social audit	1	0	1	**2**

2 The questions asked

Civil society and NGOs

asked 4 times

2025 Q8(a) — What do you understand by civil society in the Indian context? Discuss its key features and the limitations it faces in a democratic system.

2025 Q8(b) — In what ways can the role of NGOs be enhanced in promoting women's empowerment and welfare in India? Discuss, with a focus on the key challenges they encounter.

2023 Q8(b) — "NGOs play a critical role in promoting human rights, defending the marginalized, and creating a more just and equitable society." Comment on the role of NGO's in India.

2020 Q8(a) — Give the reason for the UN to partner with the civil society. Explain the importance of civil societies. Under which Acts are the NGOs in India legally registered?

Good governance, e-governance and Citizen's Charter

asked 3 times

2023 Q10(a) — Discuss the Indian experience of Citizen Charter movement and suggest solutions to improve its impact in India.

2023 Q10(b) — What are the different dimensions of governance? Briefly explain the administrative dimension of governance and its key components.

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2020 Q10(a) Why does the Indian Government make use of the e-governance strategy? Mention the several initiatives in the journey from e-governance vision to implementation. How can we say that the Indian government is accountable, responsive and legitimate government?

Right to Information (RTI) and Public Service Act

asked 3 times

2025 Q10(b) Define good governance. How does the Right to Information (RTI) Act promote the principles of good governance in India?

2023 Q8(a) The making of the Right to Information Act, 2005 in India has been largely attributed to the success of civil society movement. Comment.

2020 Q8(b) What is RTI? What rights are available under RTI Act 2005? If RTI is a Fundamental Right, then why do we need an Act to give us this Right?

Social audit

asked 2 times

2025 Q10(a) Social audit helps to narrow gaps between vision and reality. Examine the statement and also discuss the impediments in the institutionalisation of social audit in India.

2020 Q9(b) What is social audit? What are its objectives and advantages?

3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 GOOD GOVERNANCE, E-GOVERNANCE AND CITIZEN'S CHARTER ● IN THE NEWS
How does Andhra Pradesh's 'Mana Mitra' WhatsApp governance work? Can it make public services faster and more transparent?

P2 RIGHT TO INFORMATION (RTI) AND PUBLIC SERVICE ACT ● IN THE NEWS
The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 changed how the RTI Act treats personal information. Explain the change and why RTI activists are concerned.

P3 SOCIAL AUDIT ● IN THE NEWS
The VB-G RAM G Act, 2025 replaced MGNREGA and requires social audits every six months. Why are social audits important for rural job schemes?

P4 RIGHT TO INFORMATION (RTI) AND PUBLIC SERVICE ACT
What is a Public Service Guarantee Act? How does it help citizens get services on time?

P5 CIVIL SOCIETY AND NGOS
Discuss the role of women's Self-Help Groups in Andhra Pradesh as a part of civil society.

P6 GOOD GOVERNANCE, E-GOVERNANCE AND CITIZEN'S CHARTER
How can grievance redressal systems such as CPGRAMS be made more effective for ordinary citizens?

PART 8 OF 9

Ethics for public servants

8

The values, attitudes and honesty expected of public servants, and how corruption is checked.

24	8	8	8
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
Ethics basics; integrity and accountability in public and private life	2	2	1	**5**
Human values: family, education, gender equality, great leaders	2	2	2	**6**
Attitude, persuasion and emotional intelligence	2	2	2	**6**
Public-service ethics: codes, leadership, corruption, Lokpal, international ethics	2	2	3	**7**

2 The questions asked

Ethics basics; integrity and accountability in public and private life

asked 5 times

2025 Q11(a) — Public servants often face situations where personal values conflict with public responsibilities. Examine how a strong ethical foundation can help resolve such dilemmas while maintaining accountability.

2023 Q11(a) — Ethics in public service is an essential component of parliamentary democracy. In this connection, discuss the pathway towards a 'Naitik Bharat'.

2023 Q11(b) — Define Accountability. Discuss the factors that have led to weakening of accountability in civil services. Suggest ways to improve the mechanisms for accountability in civil services.

2020 Q11(a) — Define ethics, with reference to ethics in Indian tradition. Mention five principles to manage ethics in public service.

2020 Q15(b) — How does time and space effect ethics in private and public relationships? Illustrate.

Human values: family, education, gender equality, great leaders

asked 6 times

2025 Q12(a) — What ethical values are essential to ensure peaceful coexistence in a diverse society? Illustrate your answer with suitable examples.

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2025 Q12(b)	How does early value education in the family influence ethical decision-making in adulthood?
2023 Q12(a)	Discuss the significance of values in the development of personality and socio-cultural systems. Add a brief note on the hierarchy of values in India.
2023 Q12(b)	Vinoba Bhave's reform ideology had helped to nurture an ethical atmosphere in Indian public life. In this connection, evaluate the relevance of Vinoba Bhave's ideology in modern times.
2020 Q12(a)	What do you understand by the values of an entity? What is the need for value education? Discuss how gender inequality came to be recognised as inequality in the Indian context and the kind of responses that this recognition produced.
2020 Q14(b)	What is the role of family, society and educational institutions in inculcating values?

Attitude, persuasion and emotional intelligence

asked 6 times

2025 Q13(a)	Define attitude. How does attitude affect the behaviour of public servants?
2025 Q13(b)	Explain the difference between cognitive, affective and behavioural components of attitude with suitable examples in the public service context.
2023 Q13(a)	Do attitudes influence behaviour? Discuss the polarization of political attitudes in India.
2023 Q13(b)	Define Persuasion and its constructs? Can the power of persuasion be used by civil servants in order to realize the ends and objectives of a 'New India'? Substantiate.
2020 Q13(a)	Define moral attitude and explain the four qualities of moral attitude. What are the factors that shape political attitude?
2020 Q13(b)	Explain the concept of emotional intelligence with special reference to the three main models of emotional intelligence. How are emotional intelligence applied in administration and governance?

Public-service ethics: codes, leadership, corruption, Lokpal, international ethics

asked 7 times

2025 Q11(b)	Whistleblowers are guardians of ethical accountability in governance. Discuss the ethical and institutional importance of whistleblower protection in ensuring integrity in public service.
2025 Q14(a)	In what ways can the implementation of a code of ethics in public administration help in resolving conflicts of interest and promoting ethical decision-making?
2025 Q14(b)	Discuss the significance of integrity, transparency and accountability in leadership. How can public leaders demonstrate these values in their decisionmaking process?
2023 Q14(a)	Does popular democracy breed distrust in the public towards their representatives? Discuss the scope of ethical leadership in democracy and politics.
2023 Q14(b)	What is meant by 'International Ethics'? Explain the significance of [illegible] international dispute resolutions and environmental cooperation among nations.

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2020 Q12(b) Explain the Lokpal and Lokyukta Act.

2020 Q14(a) Define public service broadly. How do the virtues of trustworthiness and fortitude get manifested in public service? Explain with examples. Suggest three preventive measures of corruption.

3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 PUBLIC-SERVICE ETHICS: CODES, LEADERSHIP, CORRUPTION, LOKPAL, INTERNATIONAL ETHICS ● IN THE NEWS

India ranked 91st in Transparency International's Corruption Perceptions Index 2025. What does this index measure, and what more can be done to reduce corruption?

P2 PUBLIC-SERVICE ETHICS: CODES, LEADERSHIP, CORRUPTION, LOKPAL, INTERNATIONAL ETHICS ● IN THE NEWS

In 2025, the Supreme Court stayed a Lokpal order on hearing complaints against High Court judges. Discuss the powers and limits of the Lokpal.

P3 ETHICS BASICS; INTEGRITY AND ACCOUNTABILITY IN PUBLIC AND PRIVATE LIFE

A district officer finds that a close relative's company has bid for a contract in the officer's own department. What should the officer do? Explain the ethical principles involved.

P4 ATTITUDE, PERSUASION AND EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

What is empathy? Why is it important for civil servants who deal with poor and vulnerable people?

P5 HUMAN VALUES: FAMILY, EDUCATION, GENDER EQUALITY, GREAT LEADERS

What lessons for public life can civil servants learn from the life of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar?

P6 ETHICS BASICS; INTEGRITY AND ACCOUNTABILITY IN PUBLIC AND PRIVATE LIFE

What is meant by an ethical work culture? How can a government office build one?

PART 9 OF 9

Everyday laws: civil, criminal, labour, cyber and tax

9

The basics of the main laws an officer deals with: courts and crime, workers, the internet and taxes.

6	2	2	2
questions in 3 papers	in 2020	in 2023	in 2025

1 How many questions came from each topic

Topic	2020	2023	2025	Total
Civil and criminal law and courts (new criminal laws, Nirbhaya Act)	0	1	0	**1**
Labour laws	1	0	0	**1**
Cyber laws and cyber crime	1	0	1	**2**
Tax laws: income tax, corporate tax, GST	0	1	1	**2**

2 The questions asked

Civil and criminal law and courts (new criminal laws, Nirbhaya Act)

asked 1 time

2023 Q15(a) — [illegible] 'Substantive Law and Procedural Law' Discuss the interrelationship and differences between Substantive Law and Procedural Law.

Labour laws

asked 1 time

2020 Q11(b) — What are the necessity and importance of labour laws? Are India's labour law reforms only a gift for factories or do workers benefit too?

Cyber laws and cyber crime

asked 2 times

2025 Q15(a) — What do you understand by cyberstalking? What are the various other cyber offences recognised under Information Technology Act, 2000?

2020 Q15(a) — Explain the different types of cybercrimes and the importance of cyber laws in India.

Tax laws: income tax, corporate tax, GST

asked 2 times

2025 Q15(b) — What is GST? Discuss the regulatory framework of GST in India, including Constitutional provisions applicable to GST.

2023 Q15(b) — Are Direct Taxes transferable or non-transferable? Explain the recent Direct Tax Reforms undertaken in India.

3 Practice questions

Not from past papers. Written on the same syllabus topics, in APPSC style, to practise writing.

P1 LABOUR LAWS ● IN THE NEWS

The four Labour Codes came into force in November 2025. Explain the main changes they bring for workers and employers.

P2 CYBER LAWS AND CYBER CRIME ● IN THE NEWS

The IT Rules amendment of 2026 requires labelling of AI-generated content and faster removal of deepfakes. Explain these rules and the challenges in enforcing them.

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P3 TAX LAWS: INCOME TAX, CORPORATE TAX, GST ● IN THE NEWS

The Income-tax Act, 2025 replaces the Income-tax Act, 1961 from April 2026. Why was a new law needed, and how is it expected to make taxes simpler?

P4 CIVIL AND CRIMINAL LAW AND COURTS (NEW CRIMINAL LAWS, NIRBHAYA ACT)

Explain the three new criminal laws: the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita and the Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam. What are the main changes from the old laws?

P5 CIVIL AND CRIMINAL LAW AND COURTS (NEW CRIMINAL LAWS, NIRBHAYA ACT)

Explain the hierarchy of civil and criminal courts in a district. What is the difference between an 'order' and a 'decree'?

P6 CYBER LAWS AND CYBER CRIME

Why is it difficult to decide which court should hear a cyber-crime case? Suggest solutions.

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